The compound statement or block is a treated as a single unit and may appear anywhere in the program.

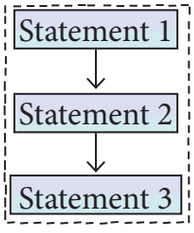
10.3 Control Statements

Control statements are statements that alter the sequence of flow of instructions.

In a program, statements may be executed sequentially, selectively or iteratively. Every programming languages provide statements to support sequence, selection (branching) and iteration.

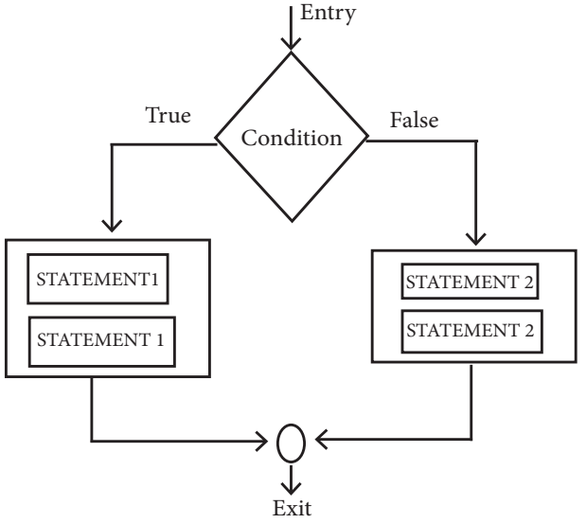
If the statements are executed sequentially, the flow is called as sequential flow. In some situations, if the statements alter the flow of execution like branching, iteration, jumping and function calls, this flow is called as control flow.

Sequence statement



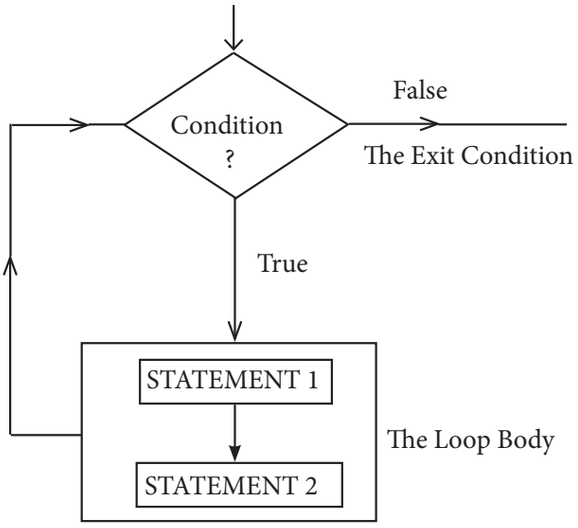
The **sequential statement** are the statements, that are executed one after another only once from top to bottom. These statements do not alter the flow of execution. These statements are called as sequential flow statements. They always end with a semicolon (;).

Selection statement



The selection statement means the statement (s) executed depend upon a condition. If a condition is true, a true block (a set of statements) is executed otherwise a false block is executed. This statement is also called **decision statement** or **selection statement** because it helps in making decision about which set of statements are to be executed.

Iteration statement



The **iteration statement** is a set of statement that are repetitively executed based upon a conditions. If a condition evaluates to true, the set of statements (true block) is executed again and again. As soon as the condition becomes false, the repetition stops. This is also known as **looping statement** or iteration statement.

The set of statements that are executed again and again is called the **body of the loop.**The condition on which the execution or exit from the loop is called **exit-condition** or **test-condition.**

Generally, all the programming languages support this type of statements to write programs depending upon the problem. C++ also supports this type of statements. These statements will be discussed in coming sections.

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